Revision:
07/01/2024

Background:
Households (HH) are required to complete a recertification prior to the end of their certification period to determine continuing eligibility.

Purpose:
This section describes the CalFresh recertification policy. It has been updated to include additional information about delayed processing and updated guidance on the recertification Notice of Action (NOA) requirements.

Policy:
CalFresh benefits may not continue beyond the end of the certification period without a new determination of eligibility. The information reported on the application for recertification, during the interview and through the verifications provided is to be used to determine continuing eligibility. Benefits for the new certification period shall be calculated using prospective budgeting and reasonably anticipated income and expenses.

1. Recertification Notice Requirements:
HHs shall be provided a CalFresh Notice of Expiration of Certification (NEC) informing them of the impending expiration of their certification period. The NEC is to be provided to the HH before the first day of the last month of the certification period, but no more than 60 days prior to the end of the certification period.

In addition to the NEC, a recertification appointment letter along with a packet containing the Recertification for CalFresh Benefits form (CF 37) shall be provided to the HH. The appointment notice specifies the date of the interview and the 15-minute time block in which the HH will be contacted. Recertification interviews shall be scheduled by the 15th day of the final month of the certification period. Documentation in the case record of when and how the HH was informed of the time-block interview appointment is required. For information on the recertification requirements for Elderly Simplified Application Project (ESAP) HHs refer to Section 63-360.

2. Application for Recertification:
HHs are required to complete an application for recertification as part of the recertification process. The application for recertification along with supporting documents may be submitted in person, by mail, fax, electronically, or over the phone with a telephonic signature and must be imaged in the case record. Any of the following forms may be accepted as the application for recertification if signed by an adult HH member:

- CF 37.
- Application for CalFresh Benefits (CF 285).
- Application for CalFresh, Cash Aid, and/or Medi-Cal/Healthcare Programs (SAWS 2 Plus).
- Initial Application for CalFresh, Cash Aid, and/or Medi-Cal/Healthcare Programs (SAWS 1).
- CalFresh Elderly Simplified Application (CF 485).

Note: The CF 485 was designed specifically for ESAP HHs; however, ESAP HHs can recertify using any acceptable application. If a non-ESAP HH provides a CF 485 it is to be accepted as an application for recertification.

3. Income Eligibility Verification System (IEVS) Processing at Recertification:
An Applicant IEVS must be ordered and processed at recertification for all HH members whose income and resources are to be considered when determining eligibility. Use the IEVS report to assist in resolving any potential discrepancies that were reported on the application for recertification or during the interview.

Note: A determination of eligibility must not be delayed while pending receipt of an Applicant IEVS.

4. Timely Applications for Recertification:
Applications filed by the 15th day of the last month of the certification period will be considered timely. In the circumstance that a HH is certified for one or two months, the application for recertification will be considered timely if the HH returns the application within 15 days of the date the NEC is provided to them. HHs that file a timely application and meet all recertification requirements by the end of the certification period are entitled to receive uninterrupted benefits by their normal issuance cycle, if determined eligible.

HHs lose their right to uninterrupted benefits when delaying the process by missing a scheduled interview and/or failing to provide requested information by the due date. A HH can still get uninterrupted benefits if all recertification requirements are completed by the end of the certification period.

5. Recertification Interview:
HHs are required to complete an interview as part of the recertification process. Contact the HH on the scheduled date and time of their interview appointment. Several attempts must be made during the 15-minute time block to contact the HH. All attempts to contact the HH must be documented in the case record. Refer to Flexible Interview Scheduling Eligibility Policy and Procedure Guide (EPPG) for further guidance.

Send a Notice of Missed Interview (NOMI) when all attempts to contact the HH during their scheduled appointment are unsuccessful. The NOMI shall be dated to reflect the end of the certification period, even when the certification period end date falls on a weekend or holiday. For more information on the interview requirements refer to Section 63-115. During the recertification interview staff are required to:

- Provide the Rights and Responsibilities (R&Rs).
- Provide the SAR 7 Eligibility Status Report requirements and instructions.
- Review information and verifications provided and clarify/resolve any missing, unclear or inconsistent information.
- Explain the verifications that are needed to complete the recertification and provide the HH with a verification checklist (VCL).
- Inform individuals subject to work registration of their requirements.

6. Delayed Processing:
An application for recertification is considered delayed when the process is not completed by the end of the last month of the certification period. The cause of the delay will be defined as follows:

Cause of Delay	Definition
County	County caused delays include, but are not limited to: • Telephonic signature was not obtained during the interview. • A valid VCL was not issued to the HH. • Assistance was not offered in obtaining required verifications. • 10 days were not allowed for the HH to submit required verifications. • The interview was not scheduled. • The interview could not be rescheduled until late in the certification period and the 10 days to provide missing verifications extended passed current certification period.
HH	HH caused delays include, but are not limited to failure to: • Complete the recertification process. • Appear for the interview. • Reschedule the interview until the month following the end of the certification period.

7. Benefit Determination for County Caused Delays:
When the recertification is delayed due to the fault of the county, once the recertification process is completed and the HH is found to be eligible for ongoing benefits, it is entitled to a full month of benefits for the first month of the new certification period. If the HH is found to be ineligible for ongoing benefits, deny the application for recertification and do not issue any benefits. Below are examples of county caused delays:

Example: County Caused Delay	
Scenario	• Certification period ends March 31. • HH submits the CF 37 on March 10. • Interview is scheduled March 11. • Interview is completed on March 11 and there are pending verifications, but the county did not send a VCL. • No verifications are provided by March 31. • The recertification is denied and a failure to provide denial NOA sent to the HH no later than March 31. • HH contacts the county on April 2 because they did not get their benefits. • VCL mailed April 2; verifications due by April 12. • HH provides verifications April 10.
Outcome	Rescind the denial, complete the recertification, and provide the full allotment to the HH within five working days of April 10.
Example: County Caused Delay	
Scenario	• Certification period ends March 31. • HH submits the CF 37 on March 10.

	• Interview is scheduled for March 15. • HH fails to complete the interview and NOMI is issued. • HH calls March 17, and the county reschedules the interview for April 2. • The recertification is denied and a failure to complete the recertification denial NOA sent to the HH no later than March 31. • Interview is completed April 2 and a VCL sent; verifications due by April 12. • HH submits verifications on April 8.
Outcome	Rescind the denial, complete the recertification and provide the full allotment to the HH within five working days of April 8.
Example: County Caused Delay	
Scenario	• Certification period ends March 31. • HH submits the CF 37 on March 10. • Interview not scheduled in March. • The recertification is denied and a failure to complete the recertification denial NOA sent to the HH no later than March 31. • HH contacts county because no benefits were issued for April. • County schedules interview for April 5. • Interview completed April 5 and a VCL is sent; verifications due by April 15. • Verification provided on April 15.
Outcome	Rescind the denial, complete the recertification and provide the full allotment to the HH within five working days of April 15.

8. Benefit Determination for HH Caused Delays:

The HH loses the right to uninterrupted benefits when it has been given at least 10 days to provide required verification and has failed to do so or has not completed the recertification interview. The HH has 30 days from the end of the certification period to complete the recertification process. If the recertification is completed within this timeframe, prorate benefits from the date the last required action was completed if the HH is found to be eligible to ongoing benefits. A HH making an untimely application for recertification will not be denied the right to complete the recertification unless they refuse to cooperate, or the delayed processing period has ended. Below are examples of HH caused delays:

Example: HH Caused Delay	
Scenario	• Certification period ends March 31. • HH submits the CF 37 on March 10. • Interview is scheduled for March 15. • Interview is completed March 15, and the VCL sent; verifications due by March 25. • Verifications are not provided by March 25. • The recertification is denied and a failure to provide denial NOA sent to the HH no later than March 31. • The HH provides the verifications late on April 3.
Outcome	Complete the recertification, issue prorated benefits as of April 3.

Example: HH Caused Delay	
Scenario	• Certification period ends March 31. • CF 37 submitted March 10. • Interview scheduled March 12. • HH fails to complete the interview; NOMI is issued. • The recertification is denied and a failure to complete the recertification denial NOA sent to the HH no later than March 31. • HH contacts the county on April 5. • Interview rescheduled for April 6. • Interview completed April 6 and a VCL is sent; verifications due by April 16. • Verifications not provided by April 16. • Denial NOA sent to the HH for failure to provide. • Verifications provided April 29.
Outcome	Complete the recertification and issue prorated benefits as of April 29.

Example: HH Caused Delay	
Scenario	• Certification period ends March 31. • CF 37 submitted March 10. • Interview scheduled March 13. • HH fails to complete the interview; NOMI is issued. • The recertification is denied and a failure to complete the recertification denial NOA sent to the HH no later than March 31. • HH contacts the county on April 4. • Interview completed April 4 and a VCL is sent; verifications due by April 14. • Verifications provided April 7.
Outcome	Complete the recertification and issue prorated benefits as of April 7.

9. 30-Day Income Verification Requirement at Recertification:

HHs are required to provide 30 days of income verification. The 30-day timeframe will be determined as follows:

If the HH…	**then…**
provides verification of the most recent 30 days of income with their recertification,	this is sufficient, and no additional verification is required.
does not provide income verification with their recertification,	verification of income must be requested for the 30 days prior to the date the VCL is provided.
provides partial or verification older than 30 days prior to recertification or date specified on the VCL, but the income can be reasonably anticipated for the upcoming payment period,	it is sufficient to use.

Example:	
Scenario	HH provides the CF 37 prior to the interview but does not provide income verification along with it. During the interview on May 3 the customer states they

	have income and verification is required to be provided.
Outcome	A VCL is provided to the HH on May 3 requesting proof of income received between April 3 and May 2 (30 days from the date the VCL is issued).

Note: For assistance calculating the 30 days refer to Desk Aid 30-Day Period Calculator.

10. Personal Contact:
Prior to terminating benefits, an attempt to contact the HH to remind them that their recertification is incomplete must be made. If successful in reaching the HH, attempt to collect the information needed to complete the recertification process. Document all call attempts in the case record.

11. NOA Requirements for Recertifications:
A recertification is an application for a new certification period and an approval or denial NOA shall be issued. Recertifications do not require 10-day notice to decrease benefits. When an application for recertification is received but the HH misses the scheduled interview or fails to provide required documents, the recertification shall be **denied** and an accurate denial NOA shall be sent. The NEC does not satisfy the requirement for denying an application for recertification. The NEC, alone, is only sufficient when the HH never submitted an application for recertification. Below are examples of which NOA shall be sent in various scenarios.

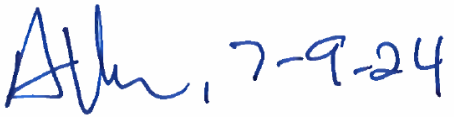
Example	
Scenario	• Certification period ends March 31. • CF 37 submitted March 12. • Interview completed March 15; VCL sent with verifications due March 25. • Verifications provided March 20.
Outcome	Approval NOA is provided.
Example	
Scenario	• Certification period ends March 31. • CF 37 submitted March 10. • Interview completed March 15; VCL sent with verifications due March 25. • Verifications are not provided by March 25.
Outcome	Failure to provide denial NOA is provided listing the items the HH did not provide.
Example	
Scenario	• Certification period ends March 31. • CF 37 submitted March 10. • Interview scheduled for March 12. • HH fails to show for the interview; NOMI is issued. • HH does not reschedule the interview by March 31.
Outcome	Denial NOA is provided to the HH no later than March 31 with the denial reason of failure to complete the recertification.
Example	
Scenario	• Certification period ends March 31. • Interview scheduled for March 12.

	• HH fails to show for the interview; NOMI is issued. • HH does not submit a CF 37 by March 31.
Outcome	No further NOA is necessary, the NEC NOA is sufficient.

References:
Manual of Policy and Procedures (MPP) 63-300.4, 63-407.3 and 63-504; All County Letter (ACL) 08-20, 12-25, 12-25E, 13-18, 13-96, 14-101, 15-84, 19-10, 19-78, 20-145, 21-24, 23-85; All County Information Notice (ACIN) I-58-13, I-33-21; Code of Federal Regulation (CFR) 273.2, 273.10, 273.13 and 273.14; Processing Guide 304-01.

Sunset Date:
This policy will be reviewed for continuance by 07/30/2027.

Approval for Release:



Rick Wanne, Director
Self-Sufficiency Services